Connecting Your FigJam Board

A step-by-step guide to building your own conversation flow in FigJam and bringing it into Gallery Guide Studio for testing.

You'll do three things in this guide: build your own flow in your own copy of the FigJam board, use the FigJam plugin to auto-generate each playbook's conversation steps, and bring the finished board into the app as an image so you can click through and test it. Follow the sections in order — each one depends on the last.

1 Get your own editable copy of the master file

• Open the link to the master FigJam file your instructor shared with you. You'll only have *view* access to this file — that's expected.

• Use FigJam's Duplicate option (File menu, or the **[Duplicate]** button) to create your own copy. This is what gives you the permission to actually edit anything — your own copy lives in your own Figma account.

• Rename your copy something you'll recognize later, e.g. your name plus the flow's purpose.

> **DO NOT EDIT THE MASTER FILE**
> Only ever make changes inside your own duplicated copy. The master file is the shared template every student starts from — editing it directly affects everyone else's starting point.

2 Design your own conversation flow

• Inside your own copy, you're free to build whatever flow diagram you like — add, remove, rearrange, or completely redesign the playbook cards.

• For each playbook card, write your own prompt in its instruction panel — this is the brief that describes what that stage of the conversation should do. You don't need to write the actual step-by-step dialogue yourself; that gets generated automatically in the next step.

• Do all of this — duplicating, designing, and writing your prompts — before moving on. The next steps depend on your board already being in its finished layout.

3 Activate the FigJam plugin

The plugin is what actually writes the generated steps into your board — it needs to be running before you click anything in the app.

• Open the **Figma desktop app** (not figma.com in a browser — this only works in the desktop app) and open your duplicated FigJam board in it.

• Right-click anywhere on the canvas → **Plugins** → **Development** → **Import plugin from manifest…**, then select the plugin's manifest.json file (get this from your instructor if you don't already have it).

- Run it from **Plugins** → **Development** → **Gallery Guide Studio — Playbook Builder**. Its panel opens on the right.

- Enter your Anthropic API key in the panel (and your initials, optional). This is stored locally by the plugin and is never sent anywhere except directly to Anthropic.

- Make sure **“Listen for Generate Steps requests from the app”** is checked (it's on by default).

> **LEAVE THE PLUGIN PANEL OPEN**
> Keep this panel open in Figma for the rest of the process. It has to be running at the same time as the app for the next step to work — if it's closed, the app has nothing to talk to.

4 Connect your FigJam file in the app

- In the app, click **[Connect FigJam file]** (top left of the canvas toolbar).

- Paste the link to **your own duplicated copy** — not the master file. Copy it straight from your browser's address bar while your copy is open.

- If you're prompted, make sure your Figma personal access token is entered under **[API keys]** too.

5 Generate the conversation steps

- Click **[Generate Steps in FigJam]** in the app.

- Switch over to Figma and **watch your board** — you should see the tables under each playbook card actually growing and filling in with generated steps in real time. This confirms it's genuinely working, not just spinning.

- Wait for this to finish before moving on. It can take a little while if your flow has several playbooks.

> **NOTHING HAPPENING?**
> If you click the button and nothing changes on your board after a minute or so, go back and check Section 3 — the plugin panel most likely isn't open, or its listening checkbox got unchecked.

6 Save your finished flow as a PNG

- Back in Figma, select your entire flow diagram — drag a selection box around all of it, or press Cmd/Ctrl+A.

- In the right-hand panel, add an **Export** setting and choose **PNG**, then export.

> **SAVE WITH A TRANSPARENT BACKGROUND**
> Make sure you are not including a solid background rectangle in your selection when you export — that's what keeps the PNG's background transparent instead of solid white.

- Save the PNG somewhere safe and easy to find again — for example, the folder you're already working in for this project.

7 Load the PNG and detect the blue buttons

- In the app, click **[Upload image]** and select the PNG you just saved.
- Wait for the image to fully load onto the canvas.
- Click **[Detect Blue Buttons]**. The app scans the image, finds each blue button, and matches it to the real content generated in Section 5.
- You should now have an interactive flowchart — every blue button on your diagram is clickable.

8 Open your first playbook

- Click the first blue button in your flow — the very start of the conversation.
- A playbook editor window opens, showing that stage's generated steps.
- Without changing anything, click **[Save]** at the bottom.

9 Start testing your conversation

- Type a message (or use the microphone) in the chat panel and send it.
- Watch it walk through your flow, stage by stage, exactly as you designed it.

Questions or something not behaving as described here? Check in with your instructor before troubleshooting on your own — it's often a one-line fix.